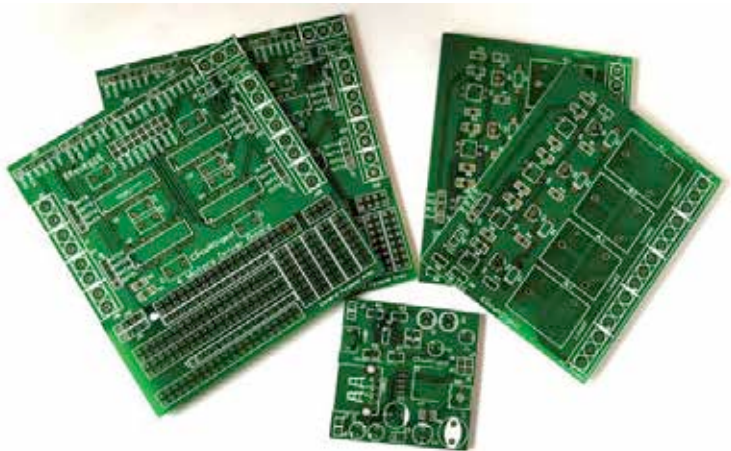




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your design will be compact and will be according to your project. There is no need to incorporate components that you don't require, making the set up less messy. Let us discuss a few preliminary steps of designing the board.

Use a laser printer to print the circuit design of your choice. Take the print out on glossy paper. Magazine sheets or photo papers can work as substitutes in case if you cannot get your hands on glossy pages. Once your print out is ready, you will be required to iron this circuit design on the copper side of the board. This process will transfer the ink onto the board and acts as a protective layer for copper against etching. Once this is done, dip the board in an etching solution, like Ferric Chloride, for fifteen minutes. To remove the solution, rinse it thoroughly with clean water. After rinsing it, the ink has to be removed. A nail lacquer works well to remove these stains.

This brings us to the last part of making your PCB. Drill holes into this and solder the components on the board. There you have it! Your very own, handmade printed circuit board!

3. The pattern materials

The printing of pattern materials has been included in the previous step. However, a few words of precautions are to be mentioned here. Use paper towels before ironing your glossy paper onto the board. This makes the process smoother. The circuit design of the Arduino is available online. Make sure the image is of high quality and resolution.